Executive Brief

Intern: UBI-2026-0210

Track: SOC_ANALYSIS

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Executive summary

A phishing email resulted in a confirmed data exfiltration incident affecting a single employee workstation (NS-WKS-101). Within approximately one minute, a malicious document executed a script that established persistence through scheduled task, compressed customer records into a zip archive, transmitted the archive to an external server and removed the local copy. The investigation found no evidence that the attack spread beyond the original device.

Incident overview

Area	Finding
Initial access	Phishing email opened by one employee (analyst1)
Affected assets	1 workstation (NS-WKS-101)
Attack duration	~1 minute
Persistence	Scheduled task created
Data exfiltration	Confirmed to external server
Lateral movement	No evidence identified

Business impact

The investigation confirmed the theft of a 53,891-byte ZIP archive containing 5,137 customer records, including reference numbers, case types, and regional codes. The archive contents and transmission were independently validated, providing high confidence in the findings.

Scope of compromise

Analysis of 100,000 activity records across 379 endpoints identified malicious activity on only the compromised workstation. No indicators of lateral movement or additional infected machines were found during the investigation.

Remaining uncertainty

The original malicious document could not be recovered, so the initial payload cannot be examined directly. Additionally, no evidence of credential theft was identified, although precautionary password rotation is recommended for the affected user.

Response status

Detection rules have been developed and tested to identify this attack pattern in future. Containment scripts are prepared to block the attacker's infrastructure and remove the malicious scheduled task, with manual approval required before execution. The affected workstation should be re-imaged to ensure complete eradication of any remaining malicious artifacts.

Key takeaway

This was a contained, single-endpoint compromise with confirmed customer data exfiltration. There is no evidence of wider organizational spread and detection and containment capabilities are ready for deployment.